Activity: Solve this

Consider two hypothetical recessive autosomal genes a and b, where a heterozygote is testcrossed to a double homozygous mutant. Predict the phenotypic ratios under the following conditions:

(a) a and b are located on separate autosomes.

(b) a and b are linked on the same autosome but are so far apart that a crossover occurs between them.

(c) a and b are linked on the same autosome but are so close together that a crossover almost never occurs.

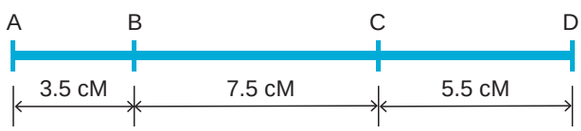
frequency) (RF) is calculated by using the following formula. The data is obtained from alleles in coupling configuration.

3.3.4 Genetic Mapping

Genes are present in a linear order along the chromosome. They are present in a specific location called **locus** (plural: loci). The diagrammatic representation of position of genes and related distances between the adjacent genes is called **genetic mapping**. It is directly proportional to the frequency of recombination between them. It is also called as **linkage map**. The concept of gene mapping was first developed by Morgan's student **Alfred H Sturtevant** in 1913. It provides clues about where the genes lies on that chromosome.

Map distance

The unit of distance in a genetic map is called a **map unit** (m.u). One map unit is equivalent to one percent of crossing over (Figure 4.). One map unit is also called a centimorgan (cM) in honour of **T.H. Morgan**. 100 centimorgan is equal to one Morgan (M). For example: A distance between A and B genes is estimated to be 3.5 map units. It is equal to 3.5 centimorgans or 3.5 % or 0.035 recombination frequency between the genes.



Uses of genetic mapping

- It is used to determine gene order, identify the locus of a gene and calculate the distances between genes.
- They are useful in predicting results of dihybrid and trihybrid crosses.
- It allows the geneticists to understand the overall genetic complexity of particular organism.

3.4 Multiple alleles

A given phenotypic trait of an individual depends on a single pair of genes, each of which occupies a specific position called the locus on homologous chromosome. When any of the three or more allelic forms of a gene occupy the same locus in a given pair of homologous chromosomes, they are said to be called **multiple alleles**.

Check your Grasp

There may be multiple alleles within the population, but individuals have only two of those alleles. Why?

3.4.1 Characteristics of multiple alleles

- Multiple alleles of a series always occupy the same locus in the homologous chromosome. Therefore, no crossing over occurs within the alleles of a series.
- Multiple alleles are always responsible for the same character.
- The wild type alleles of a series exhibit dominant character whereas mutant type will influence dominance or an intermediate phenotypic effect.
- When any two of the mutant multiple alleles are crossed the phenotype is always mutant type and not the wild type

3.4.2 Self-sterility in *Nicotiana*

In plants, multiple alleles have been reported in association with self-sterility or self-incompatibility. Self-sterility means that the

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